

Spirit of Seduction

Seduce- to persuade to disobedience or disloyalty, to lead astray, to entice, to lure.

I Timothy 4:1-2 *"¹The Spirit clearly says that in later times some will abandon the faith and follow deceiving spirits and things taught by demons. ²Such teachings come through hypocritical liars, whose consciences have been seared as with a hot iron."*

In **John 16:3** we see the writer talking about the hate the world has for the disciples. **Verse 1-4** *"¹All this I have told you so that you will not go astray. ²They will put you out of the synagogue; in fact, a time is coming when anyone who kills you will think he is offering a service to God. ³They will do such things because they have not known the Father or me. ⁴I have told you this, so that when the time comes you will remember that I warned you."*

In **John 16:13** we are given a promise *"¹³But when he, the Spirit of truth, comes, he will guide you into all truth. He will not speak on his own; he will speak only what he hears, and he will tell you what is yet to come"*

Manifestations/Symptoms of Seduction:

- Hypocritical lies
- Seared conscience
- Attractions-false prophets, signs and wonders
- Deception
- Wander from the truth
- Fascination with evil ways, objects or persons
- Seducers-enticers
- Music- Rock, Country, Rap, etc.
- Members of any religious cult
- Jezebel- manipulations, over ride authority, always blame someone else when caught.

These manifestations/strongmen are even more active in the last days as evil becomes almost irresistible. Their target is people who have accepted Jesus as their personal Lord and Savior.

If the enemy can't entice Christians to do the usual sins, then he will begin to use false religions in order to draw them away. He will begin

to pervert the Word in order to cause division as possible the enemy will cause believers to depart from the faith and embrace religions invented by the enemy. The spirit of seduction wants to place a question in your mind about the Will, the Purpose, and the Word of God for your life.

Exactly how does Satan seduce a Christian? **James 1:14-15** ¹³*When tempted, no one should say, "God is tempting me." For God cannot be tempted by evil, nor does he tempt anyone; ¹⁴**but each one is tempted when, by his own evil desire, he is dragged away and enticed.** ¹⁵*Then, after desire has conceived, it gives birth to sin; and sin, when it is full-grown, gives birth to death.*"*

Temptation comes from the evil desires inside us, not from God. It becomes sin when we dwell on the thought and allow it to become an action.

God will test you but he will never tempt you to fail morally...

This is the identical tactic Satan used on Eve in the Garden of Eden. The lure or temptation was dangled before her eyes by the serpent. **Genesis 3:6** ⁶*when the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it.*" (NIV)

Message Bible ⁶*When the Woman saw that the tree looked like good eating and realized what she would get out of it--she'd know everything!-- she took and ate the fruit and then gave some to her husband, and he ate."*

Only when she allowed her lust or fleshly desire to RESPOND to the lure did she sin. When the temptation moved into the action state it became sin.

Many times the Spirit of seduction will cause you to get your attention off the things of God and on to those around you. When this happens we begin to make excuses for the sin in our lives.

When we begin to seek revelation from sources other than the Word of God, we are opening ourselves up to be seduced by other spirits than the spirit of God.

Isaiah 30:1 ¹*Woe to the obstinate children," declares the LORD , "to those who carry out plans that are not mine, forming an alliance, but not by my Spirit, heaping sin upon sin"* (NIV)

NKJV *"Woe to the rebellious children," says the LORD, "Who take counsel, but not of Me, And who devise plans, but not of My Spirit, That they may add sin to sin"*

When we take council from another source other than the spirit of God it's always easier to lay the blame of our sin and troubles off on someone else.

How does this work?

It is easy to blame others and make excuses for evil thoughts and wrong actions. The excuses include:

- It's the other persons fault
- I couldn't help it
- Everybody else is doing it
- It was just a mistake, a one time thing.
- Nobody's perfect
- The devil made me do it
- I was pressured in to doing it

A person who makes excuses is trying to shift the blame from himself/herself to something or someone else.

Such is the case with Jezebel...

Jezebel

Revelations 2:20 ^{v20}*Nevertheless, I have this against you: You tolerate that woman Jezebel, who calls herself a prophetess. By her teaching she misleads my servants into sexual immorality and the eating of food sacrificed to idols. ²¹I have given her time to repent of her immorality, but she is unwilling. ²²So I will cast her on a bed of suffering, and I will make those who commit adultery with her suffer intensely, unless they repent of her ways. ²³I will strike her children dead. Then all the churches will know that I am he who searches hearts and minds, and I will repay each of you according to your deeds."*

In order to understand the spirit of Jezebel, we must first understand the genesis of this personality in the Bible. The first mention of Jezebel is seen in the rebellious, manipulative wife of King Ahab.

This one spirit was almost totally responsible for corrupting an entire nation. This principality has made full circle into the modern church.

Jezebel literally means "without co-habitation" or better said she refuses to "live together" or "co-habitat: Jezebel will not dwell with anyone unless she can control and dominate the relationship. When she seems "submissive" or "servant-like" it's only to gain some strategic advantage.

Although Jezebel is referred to as a she, this spirit is without gender. The spirit of Jezebel can operate through a male as well as a female.

When this spirit is in operation through a female, you will see a woman who, because of insecurity, jealousy, or vanity, desires to dominate others.

Jezebel is behind the woman who publicly humiliates her husband with her tongue, and there-after controls him by his fear of public embarrassment.

While Jezebel can use every means of sexual perversity known in hell, immorality is not the issue; control is what she seeks.

Characteristics of Jezebel:

Manipulation

Intimidation

Domination

Illegitimate Rule

Hungers for Control

Inability to co-habitat

Resents Strong Male Leadership

Controls her Environment

Comes from a dysfunctional family (sexually unclean, mental illness, abuse)

Makes those who challenge her inferior

Defensive/ Reacts with hostility

Must know everything going on in the church

Uses God as a means not to submit to authority "the Lord told me"

She hates repentance, prayer, humility, and the work of grace

I did a study of Jezebels father. His name was Ethbaal, meaning "with Baal" and "toward the idol". He is said to have been priest of Astarte, whose worship was closely allied to that of Baal. This may account for his daughter's zeal in promoting idolatry in Israel. The same goes for the founder of Carthridge, Jezebel was his granddaughter.

(Generational curses???)

Other Seducing Spirits

I want to speak to you about the spirit of Cain, the spirit of Balaam and the spirit of Korah.

Jude 1:11 ¹¹*Woe unto them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and ran greedily after the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core."*

These spirits work together in the church and seek to abort the potential in other persons in the Kingdom of God.

Let's look first at the Spirit of Cain.

Cain

I John 3:11 ¹¹*This is the message you heard from the beginning: We should love one another. ¹²Do not be like Cain, who belonged to the evil one and murdered his brother. And why did he murder him? Because his own actions were evil and his brother's were righteous."*

What is the mark of Cain?

- Spiritual Jealousy. If the way of Cain is in your spirit, jealousy will be the ruler of your life.
- The spirit of Cain does not want anybody to have more of the spirit than he has himself.
- He has great anger to the point of assonating anyone who has more of the spirit than he does.
- He compares himself to the competition and then eliminates the competition. He can't accept a brother who has a greater giftedness and ability than himself. (Example: What are people doing when they are watching a ball game? They are questioning the ability of the coach to use the talent he's been working with all year. We all grip because he calls the wrong play.....The way of Cain, because of spiritual jealousy, will cause you to criticize the teacher, preacher.)
- Cain was jealous of Able because he had favor with God so he killed him. Cain wanted the place of favor.

How do you feel when someone is promoted above you in church?
How do you feel when someone is promoted above you on your job?
How do you feel when someone makes a decision without consulting you first?

Balaam

Revelation 2:14 ¹⁴*But I have a few things against you, because you have there those who hold the doctrine of Balaam, who taught Balak to put a stumbling block before the children of Israel,"*

II Peter 2:15-16 ¹⁵*They have forsaken the right way and gone astray, following the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of unrighteousness; ¹⁶but he was rebuked for his iniquity: a dumb donkey speaking with a man's voice restrained the madness of the prophet."*

Balaam was willing to acknowledge that God was indeed a powerful God, but he did not believe in the Lord as the only true God.

His story exposes the deception of maintaining an outward façade of spirituality over a corrupt inward life.

This seducing spirit teaches people to go their own way and that doctrine is not important.

The spirit of Balaam says go ahead and do it if it feels good. It doesn't matter what people think. You can wear what ever you want.... Etc...

Balaam was a man ready to obey God's commands as long as he could profit from doing so.

This mixture of motives—obedience and profit—eventually recognizing to Balaam's death. Although he recognizing the power of God, his heart was occupied with the wealth he could gain in Moab, and there he eventually returned to die.

Who and what we are will somehow come to the surface, destroying any masks we may have put on to cover up our real selves. These people can go into the world and do what they want and come into the church and feel no convictions about it.

Our time would be better spent on dealing with the sin in our lives as opposed to wasting the effort and time trying to hide it from God.

The spirit of Balaam will lead you away from the truth and will convince you that the sin you started out feeling bad about, is no longer a sin Then you no longer has a conscience about it.
Life lessons to learn from Balaam:

- Motives are just as important as actions.
- Your treasure is where your heart is.

Korah

Jude 11 ¹¹*Woe unto them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and ran greedily after the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core.*” This is the New Testament referring back to the Old Testament.

This word “gainsaying” in the Greek means “anti-logia” or “anti-logos.” What being said is saying is that they speak against the Word. The Word says “*in the beginning was the Word*” or in the beginning was the “logos”

A person that has gone the way of Korah will speak against what the teacher is teaching and what the preacher is preaching. (Example, I don’t like going to so and so’s class.....)

Verse 8 in Jude ⁸*Likewise also these filthy dreamers defile the flesh, despise dominion, and speak evil of dignities.”*

Verse 16 ¹⁶*These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their own lusts; and their mouth speaketh great swelling words, having men's persons in admiration because of advantage.”*

You must be careful who you talk about. Someone that had gone the way of Korah is not afraid to challenge God’s man in order to raise themselves up in the eyes of the people.

Numbers 16 Korah died for speaking against God’s man. In Numbers 16 These men felt that Moses and Aaron were not the kind of leadership they deserved. They felt they were as gifted as Moses and Aaron were, and they may have been, but they didn’t have the call of God upon their lives. (The anointing)

READ NUMBERS 16 (NIV)

Korah was a Levite who assisted in the daily functions of the tabernacle. Shortly after Israel's great rebellion against God (Numbers 13; 14), Korah instigated his own mini rebellion. He recruited a grievance committee and confronted Moses and Aaron.

Their list of complaints boils down to three statements:

- (1) You are n**o** better than anyone else;
- (2) Everyone in Israel has been chosen of the Lord;
- (3) We don't need to ~~be~~ you. It is amazing to see how Korah twisted the first two statements—both true—to reach the wrong conclusion.

Moses would have agreed that he was no better than anyone else. He would also have agreed that all Israelites were God's chosen people. But Korah's application of these truths was wrong.

Not all Israelites were chosen ~~here~~ Not everyone in congregation we are apart of is called to lead.....

Korah's hidden claim was this: "I have as much right to lead as Moses does." His error cost him not only his job—a position of service that he enjoyed—but also his life.

Korah's story gives us numerous warnings:

- (1) Don't let desire for what someone else has; make discontented with what you already have.
- (2) Don't try to raise your self-esteem by attacking someone else.
- (3) Don't use a Pastor of God's Word to support what you want, rather than allowing its entirety to shape your wants.
- (4) Don't expect to find satisfaction in power and position; God may want to work through you in the position you are now in.

Just because a person is talented doesn't mean they are called to a place.

The worst thing you can do in your home is to rip the leadership of the church apart.